BRAIN 04

Dihexa

Small modified peptide made from angiotensin IV (N-hexanoic-Tyr-Ile-(6) aminohexanoic amide)



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide	Memory in dementia models	Lab or animal only	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

- **Memory** — ANIMAL
- **Alzheimer's model** — ANIMAL
- **Inner-ear hair cells** — ANIMAL
- **Sciatic nerve repair** — ANIMAL

No human study published. FDA has not identified any human exposure data. The main paper on how it acts was retracted in 2025.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Dihexa ▶ HGF binding ▶ c-Met signals ▶ New synapses

- **Reported** to bind HGF and raise c-Met signalling (lab work, paper retracted 2025)
- **New nerve-cell connections** seen in the developers' lab tests
- **2013 founding paper** has a journal notice of concern (2021)
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

LAB OR ANIMAL
LEVEL 1 OF 5

- Rat, mouse, zebrafish and cell studies only
- No human study or registered trial
- Key mechanism paper retracted in 2025

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Any human exposure data
- Safety in people
- Half-life in people
- Dose in people

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	None studied in people (by mouth in rats)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established in people	No approved product; not on FDA compounding lists
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Not established (no human trials)	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; was Category 2 (nominations withdrawn)
HHS	Not in the Oct 2026 peptide policy
WADA	Not named; S0 status not stated

REFERENCES

1. FDA, bulk drug substances that may present significant safety risks (Category 2), Apr 2026
2. J Pharmacol Exp Ther, first description of dihexa (McCoy et al.), Jan 2013
3. J Pharmacol Exp Ther, retraction notice for Benoist et al. 2014, Apr 2025

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